

Poetry Study





About the Course

Students study poetic devices and forms and practice writing poetry themselves.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Poetry: Grade 7



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Poetry Study: Grade 7 1 time/week 20 min	What Is Poetry?

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Poetry: Grade 7				
Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Study: Grade 7



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 7

☐ Some of the poems are given as links or PDFs. You may want to print those out.

☐ Make sure the student has a Commonplace Book to write down any poems they especially enjoy. You will want to remind them to do that during poetry time, or set another time in the afternoon to do that.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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What Is Poetry?



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Poetry Study: Grade 7

How To Teach



Introduce

Tell something about the poet or the kind of poem or fable to prepare students. Remember that poems are like paintings—they not only convey ideas, they create an experience with the sound of words, the way the words are arranged, and the emotions, thoughts, and images they evoke.



Read

Read the poem aloud in order to hear the sounds and meter. Have students read it aloud as well as it is helpful to hear poetry read by different voices. Try to read paying attention to the punctuation as well as the line breaks to get the sense of the poem.



Discuss

Allow students to share any thoughts or connections. What are your impressions of the poem? Talk about anything that stood out to you: the images, ideas, words, phrases, sounds, or even physical look of the poem. What kinds of things is the poem about?



Reread

Read (or have the student read) the poem again.



Connect

Students may choose to add poems to their Commonplace Book or mark them to copy later.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ INTRO

What makes something a poem? Let's explore this question in our book by British poet, Poet Laureate (2007-2009), and author Michael Rosen.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Suggest Things Ch.1 p.1-6

- Rosen writes, "They don't try to give us answers. They leave us to do a lot of the figuring out." Read the poem below and ask questions about it and what it might be saying. You don't have to know the answers.

"The Listeners"

By Walter De La Mare

'Is there anybody there?' said the Traveller,
Knocking on the moonlit door;
And his horse in the silence champed the grasses
Of the forest's ferny floor:
And a bird flew up out of the turret,
Above the Traveller's head:
And he smote upon the door again a second time;
'Is there anybody there?' he said.
But no one descended to the Traveller;
No head from the leaf-fringed sill
Leaned over and looked into his grey eyes,
Where he stood perplexed and still.
But only a host of phantom listeners
That dwelt in the lone house then
Stood listening in the quiet of the moonlight
To that voice from the world of men:
Stood thronging the faint moonbeams on the dark stair,
That goes down to the empty hall,
Harkening in an air stirred and shaken
By the lonely Traveller's call.
And he felt in his heart their strangeness,
Their stillness answering his cry,
While his horse moved, cropping the dark turf,
'Neath the starred and leafy sky;
For he suddenly smote on the door, even
Louder, and lifted his head:—
'Tell them I came, and no one answered,
That I kept my word,' he said.
Never the least stir made the listeners,
Though every word he spake
Fell echoing through the shadowiness of the still house
From the one man left awake:
Ay, they heard his foot upon the stirrup,
And the sound of iron on stone,
And how the silence surged softly backward,
When the plunging hoofs were gone.

WEEK 2 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem suggests things?

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Give an Impression, Poetry Can Play With Words Ch.1 p.7-19

- How does the author, Eugene Field, play with words in the poem "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"?
- ∞ Link: "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"

WEEK 3 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem gives an impression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Be Symbolic, Poetry Can Be Personal Ch.1 p.20-27

- Rosen said that "Tennyson has turned the eagle into a person and then into a symbol of power" (p.23). Giving animals or things feelings, ideas, and thoughts so they can behave in ways people behave is called personification. Read the poem "The Oven Bird" by Robert Frost. What kinds of feelings and thoughts is he giving to the bird? The oven bird's song is "teacher, teacher, teacher." Could the bird be teaching us a lesson?
- ∞ Link: "The Oven Bird"
- ∞ Video Link: Song of the Ovenbird

WEEK 4 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 4

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that poetry can be personal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Borrow Voices Ch.1 p.28-41

WEEK 5 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 5

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that poetry can borrow voices?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Capture a Moment, Poetry Can Be Ironic Ch.1 p.42-51

WEEK 6 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 6

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that poetry can capture a moment?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Make New Sense Ch.1 p.52-61

WEEK 7 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 7

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that poetry can make new sense?

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Make Familiar Things Feel Unfamiliar Ch.1 p.62-70

WEEK 8 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 8

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ INTRO

Now that you have been reading this book and thinking about what poetry can do, what new ideas have you discovered about poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

What Can You Do With a Poem? Ch.2 p.71-76 "Sometimes the best" - "That's fine, too!"

- Pick a poem or a section of a poem you've read recently and ask yourself the questions from the reading.

WEEK 9 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 9

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ INTRO

In your last reading, what did you learn about what you can do with poems?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

What Can You Do With a Poem? Ch.2 p.76-82 "Poems bring" - "cat as well."

- Pick a poem or a section of a poem you've read recently and ask yourself the questions from the reading.

WEEK 10 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 10

Materials: What Is Poetry?, PDF (printed)

PREP: Print out the poem so students can mark the page.

∞ PDF Link: "The Lighthouse" by Henry Wadsworth Longfellow

→ INTRO

You will receive a printout of a poem to mark up like the poem we looked at last week on p.78-79.

→ READ

Look for the following items in the poem and mark accordingly:

1. alliteration (words begin with the same letter)
2. assonance (words use the same vowel sounds)
3. words (or groups of words are repeated)
4. imagery (word picture)
5. opposites
6. rhyme scheme (Ex. ABAB)

WEEK 11 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 11

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

What Can You Do With a Poem? Ch.2 p.83-88 "People say" - "rediscover it later!"

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Term 1	
• Pick a poem or a section of a poem you've read recently and ask yourself the questions from the reading.	
WEEK 12 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: What Is Poetry?	

Poetry Study: Grade 7

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 13

Materials: What Is Poetry? & journal/notebook

→ INTRO

We are going to write poetry for the rest of the year. Does that make you excited or scared? We will have fun experimenting with different techniques and kinds of poems. No one will judge your poetry. The only way to get good at writing poetry or prose is to write. We are skipping ahead to Ch.6 to learn some technical points about poems that you can use in your poems.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Some Technical Points About Poems Ch.6 p.159-168

- How does rhythm affect a poem?
- What are the different ways to play with the sounds of a poem?

→ WRITE

Put the bold words and their definitions in your notebook to reference them when writing your poems.

WEEK 2 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 14

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ INTRO

How do you feel about writing your poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

What Can You Do With a Poem? Ch.3 p.89-95 "When we write" - "Perhaps not."

- Explore using hyperbole to talk about a feeling besides anger. How could you create a poem similar to "I am Angry"?

→ WRITE

Write a poem that expresses an emotion using hyperbole. It should be at least 4 couplets long. (2 lines in a row that rhyme)

WEEK 3 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 15

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Feeling Ill Ch.3 p.96-99

- What techniques did the author use in this poem to express that he was sick and bored? How would you use them to create a poem about an event from your memory?

→ WRITE

Create a poem about an event from your memory using -ing words. Have the first and last lines be the same.

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Term 2

WEEK 4 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 16

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Fooling Around Ch.3 p.100-105
 2. "Down Behind the Dustbin" by Michael Rosen
- ∞ Link: "Down Behind the Dustbin"

→ WRITE

Create your own "Do you know what?" or "Down Behind the Dustbin" poem. You want to use the same rhyme scheme as the author: A B C B.

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch Michael Rosen perform his poem ""Down Behind the Dustbin"" live.

∞ Video Link: Performance by Rosen

WEEK 5 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 17

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Today; One Day Ch.3 p.106-111

- How is a poem a conversation between two sets of thoughts: the poet's and the reader's?
- Explore impossible writing by thinking of other examples of extreme writing; for instance, things that are ironic or mysterious and don't seem to go together. How could you create a poem about one?

→ WRITE

Create your own "Impossible writing" poem. You may need to finish it in the afternoon.

WEEK 6 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 18

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

The Lift Ch.3 p.112-114

- Explore the use of imagining as a jumping-off point for a poem. What are some things you have seen or heard that made you wonder?

→ WRITE

Create your poem about something you wonder about, whether silly or serious.

WEEK 7 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 19

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ INTRO

After you read some more ways to start a poem, you will finish the chapter about the technical points of poems.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ways to Start a Poem Ch.4 p.115-118

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Term 2

2. Some Technical Points about Poems Ch.6 p.169-179

- Do you like to daydream? Do you have a special place that is more conducive to that?

→ WRITE

1. Work on the lists mentioned on p.116-117.
2. Write the words in bold from Ch.6 and define them so you can use this list as a reference for writing your poems.

WEEK 8 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 20

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Pretend You're Someone Else Ch.4 p.119-120
2. Read this poem by Emily Dickinson. Who is she pretending to be?

"Bee! I'm expecting you!"

Bee! I'm expecting you!
Was saying Yesterday
To Somebody you know
That you were due—

The Frogs got Home last Week—
Are settled, and at work—
Birds, mostly back—
The Clover warm and thick—

You'll get my Letter by
The seventeenth; Reply
Or better, be with me—
Yours, Fly.

- What interesting person or animal could you pretend to be when writing a poem?

→ WRITE

Create a poem where you are pretending to be someone else. Try to incorporate some of the elements from your reference list into your poem.

WEEK 9 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 21

Materials: What Is Poetry?, journal/notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pick a Moment Ch.4 p.121-124

→ WRITE

Over the next two weeks, you will work on a poem that comes from one of the moments that you read about. First, take some time to pick one of the moments. After you pick the moment, go back to the paragraph that discusses that particular moment, and jot down ideas for your poem. You can use phrases or bullet points. You don't have to write your ideas in complete sentences. Remember that for the next two weeks, you will be working on your poem, so you don't have to finish today.

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Term 2

WEEK 10 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 22

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ **RECAP**

What did you read about last time?

→ **INTRO**

Before you work on your poem based on a moment, let's read a well-known poem titled "I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud" by William Wordsworth about a moment he had in nature.

∞ Link: "I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud"

→ **WRITE**

Work on your poem based on a moment. If you need more inspiration, read p.121-124.

WEEK 11 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 23

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ **WRITE**

Finish your poem. When you are finished, it is good to go back and see if you need to change any words or fix any errors.

WEEK 12 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
What Is Poetry?

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Term 3

WEEK 1 ☐ 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 25

☐ Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Start with a Picture, Play with Dreams, Fantasies and Nonsense Ch.4 p.124-128

- Which of these ideas for writing poetry resonates with you?

→ WRITE

Based on today's suggestions, decide what kind of poem you want to write. Then, jot down ideas and phrases in your notebook. You will write the poem next week.

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 26

☐ Materials: Journal/Notebook

→ WRITE

Use this time to write your poem, using your ideas from last week.

WEEK 3 ☐ 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 27

☐ Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Celebrate your Culture and Traditions Ch.4 p.129-132

- What things in your culture or tradition could you write about?

→ WRITE

Based on your answers to the questions in the reading, follow the directions that begin at the bottom of p.131 and jot down ideas for a poem. You will write the poem next week.

WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 28

☐ Materials: Journal/Notebook

→ WRITE

Use this time to write your poem, using your ideas from last week.

WEEK 5 ☐ 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 29

☐ Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Writing Poem Ch.5 p.133-137

- Which of these ideas for writing poetry resonates with you?

→ WRITE

Try some "less is more" or "impossible writing." Choose one of those

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Term 3

categories for writing a poem. Today, you will try to get some phrases down on paper that you can work with later. You will come back to these ideas next week and create a poem.

WEEK 6 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 30

Materials: Journal/Notebook

→ WRITE

Use this time to write your poem, using your ideas from last week.

WEEK 7 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 31

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Chorus, Call and Response, Question and Answer Ch.5 p.135-140
2. Read this example of a Call and Response
∞ Link: "I Gave My Love a Cherry Tree"

- Which of these ideas for writing poetry resonates with you?

→ WRITE

Pick one of the ideas you read about today and jot down ideas for your poem. Write down some phrases that you can work on later. You will come back to these ideas next week and create a poem.

WEEK 8 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 32

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ WRITE

Using your ideas from last week, use this time to write your poem.

WEEK 9 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 33

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Wordplay, Imagism Ch.5 p.141-148 (top)

- Which of these ideas for writing poetry resonates with you?

→ WRITE

Write a poem using wordplay or imagism.

WEEK 10 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 34

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Symbolism, Long and Short Ch.5 p.148-153 (top)

- Which of these ideas for writing poetry resonates with you?

→ WRITE

Write a poem using symbolism, long and short, or volcano page.

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Term 3

WEEK 11 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 35

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Things to Do with Your Poems Ch.5 p.153-158

- Which of these ideas for sharing poetry resonates with you?
- What has been your experience writing poetry? Was it hard? Was it enjoyable?

→ **WRITE**

Answer the following question in your notebook: So what is poetry?

WEEK 12 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
What Is Poetry?

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Examination

- Term 1** · What Is Poetry?: How can poetry borrow voices, capture a moment, or make new sense? Give an example from your reading in the book or from the term's poetry.
- Term 2** · What Is Poetry?: Tell about some of the ways the author has introduced starting poems, and share which ones you enjoyed most.
- Term 3** · Share a poem you wrote this term and explain which ideas from "What Is Poetry?" started it.